## The Foundation of the United States of America

The states had been originally grouped together in a somewhat loose confederation in 1777. All of the states sent representatives to a meeting in Philadelphia to create a more formal arrangement. A new constitution was created in 1787 and two years later, George Washington was elected as the First President of the United States of America. In 1791, the Bill of Rights was created with the famous first ten amendments.

The population of the United States continued to grow at a rapid pace during the 18th and 19th centuries. From all over Europe, new migrants came and settled in America. The existing Americans began to migrate to the west and founded new cities as they settled down. Vermont became the 14th state in 1791 and Kentucky was founded in the following year. In 1796, Tennessee was also added to the ever growing list of American states. At the turn of the 19th century, America purchased Louisiana from France with great economic difficulty. America bought the French lands for $15,000,000 and made it the 18th state of the country.